Bulletin

Last updated 23-10-2026 at 20:11 — Covering sources published on 23 October 2026

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Data protection

- **UN expert highlights global challenges to international transfer of personal data** — Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights, 23 October 2026 GLOBAL

  In a report to the UN General Assembly, the Special Rapporteur on the right to privacy, Ana Brian Nougrères, found that none of the cross-border transfer instruments she reviewed, from adequacy decisions to standard contractual clauses and binding corporate rules, protects privacy by itself. She urged States to negotiate a legally binding international instrument on data transfers, and asked for low-cost tools so developing countries and small firms can use transfer mechanisms and for data protection to be written into digital trade agreements. *Also under Standards.*

- **JNPDP 2026 : l'IPDCP mobilise les citoyens pour une meilleure protection des données personnelles** — Levisionnaire, 23 October 2026 TOGO

  Togo's data protection authority, the IPDCP, will hold the country's first National Personal Data Protection Day in Lomé on 29 October 2026, on personal data and digital sovereignty, with a panel of counterpart authorities from Benin, Burkina Faso, Mali and Senegal. Ahead of it, the authority planned an awareness session for over 250 young people in Dapaong on 24 October and announced a network of more than 500 volunteers to carry its messages locally. *Also under Literacy.*

Regional collaboration

- **Yaoundé Declaration Targets 100% Local Hosting of Critical Government Data by 2030** — Business in Cameroon, 23 October 2026 CAMEROON AFRICA

  The Yaoundé Declaration on E-Governance and Artificial Intelligence in Africa, adopted when the E-Gov'A conference closed on 17 October 2026, asks African governments to host all classified critical or sovereign public data inside their own borders by 2030, and where domestic capacity is lacking to prefer another African country over providers off the continent. The organisers, Smart Click Africa and Digital Business Africa, are to run an African Observatory for E-Government and AI; the hosting target is a recommendation and binds no government. *Also under Digital sovereignty and Data Storage.*

- **Cameroon summit calls for interoperable DPI and sovereign infrastructure in Africa** — Biometric Update, 23 October 2026 CAMEROON

  A second account of the Yaoundé Declaration, adding its call for interoperable digital identity, payments and data-exchange systems built on open standards, and for a once-only principle under which citizens are not asked again for information an administration already holds. *Also under Data Exchange and Data Storage.*

Standards

- **Nigeria, UK deepen collaboration on AI standards, digital economy** — The Guardian Nigeria, 23 October 2026 NIGERIA

  The British Standards Institution and Nigeria's National Centre for Artificial Intelligence and Robotics ran an executive workshop on AI governance and standards for senior officials and regulators, under the UK's Digital Access Programme, covering ISO/IEC 42001 and ISO/IEC 23894. The British High Commission presented it as part of several years of BSI work with NITDA, the Standards Organisation of Nigeria and the data protection regulator. *Also under AI*.

- **UN expert highlights global challenges to international transfer of personal data** — Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights, 23 October 2026 GLOBAL

  Summarised under Data protection.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **RDC : Tshisekedi, à moins de deux ans de la fin de son dernier mandat, toujours pas d'État numérisé** — NBS Infos, 23 October 2026 DRC

  An opinion piece by economist Jo M. Sekimonyo, chancellor of Université Lumumba, argues that DR Congo still lacks a digitised state almost eight years into Félix Tshisekedi's presidency, despite the 2023 digital code giving electronic documents the same legal value as paper. He holds that scattered platforms and strategies have left core administrative procedures untouched, citing the presidency's correspondence handling, and urges the executive to refocus on digitising the state as a whole. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov*.

- **Intelligence artificielle et souveraineté numérique : le Mali face aux défis de la gouvernance et de la désinformation** — Agence Malienne de Presse (AMAP), 23 October 2026 MALI

  In an interview with Mali's national news agency, digital governance specialist Tidiani Togola, founder of Tuwindi, said Mali has made a start on AI, with the CIAR-Mali centre's Kati site opened in September and a Tier III national data centre in service since January, but has published no national AI strategy. He noted that the personal data law dates from 2013, that about 35% of Malians use the internet, and that WIPO's Global Innovation Index 2025 puts Mali 135th of 139. *Also under AI and Digital sovereignty*.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

- **PR autoriza 50 milhões USD para levar banda larga a zonas sem cobertura, mas OGE prevê 67 milhões** — Polígrafo África, 23 October 2026 ANGOLA

  A presidential despacho signed on 14 October 2026 authorises USD 50 million to extend broadband to unserved areas of Angola, schools and care homes first, through a public tender run under the director-general of the Instituto de Modernização Administrativa. Polígrafo África sets this against a 2026 state budget line of Kz 62.7 billion, about USD 67 million, for the national broadband network. *Also under Connectivity*.

New investments

- **Nigeria's First Lady Lays Foundation for Abuja Innovation Hub** — Voice of Nigeria, 23 October 2026 NIGERIA

Nigeria's First Lady, Oluremi Tinubu, laid the foundation stone of the Renewed Hope Startup Hub in Wuye, Abuja, funded by a USD 10.4 million grant from Japan through JICA and intended for incubation, hardware prototyping and research. NITDA's director-general said the agency's programmes had supported more than 995 startups and created about 7,596 jobs over three years. *Also under Innovation ecosystem.*

- **Kenya's Konza Technopolis Secures Funding Agreement for Data Centre and Smart City Project** — Tech Africa News, 23 October 2026 KENYA

  A second account of the Konza cloud expansion agreement, naming the counterparty as the PPP Project Facilitation Fund under the National Treasury and listing feasibility work and an investment framework among the costs it covers. *Also under Data Storage.*

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **Orange Liberia Launches 5G as Liberia's First Provider** — Tech Africa News, 23 October 2026 LIBERIA

  Orange Liberia launched 5G and presented itself as the country's first 5G provider. It gave no coverage areas, service packages or rollout scale.

- **Govt plans 2 000km fibre network to expand internet access in Eswatini schools** — Eswatini Positive News, 23 October 2026 ESWATINI

  Eswatini's ICT minister Savannah Maziya said on Eswatini TV that the ministry will lay about 2,000 km of fibre to bring free Wi-Fi to more than 800 schools, and aims to build digital skills for about 200,000 people. She gave no timetable or cost. *Also under Access to services.*

- **Airtel, Globacom, MTN face network quality probe** — ITWeb Africa, 23 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Nigeria's House of Representatives summoned the chief executives of MTN Nigeria, Airtel Nigeria and Globacom to appear before an ad hoc committee on 28 October 2026 over network quality, following an MTN outage in early October across several states and the capital. NCC figures put fibre cuts at 44,678 from January to September 2026, alongside 23,954 cases of denied site access, 73% of them attributed to insecurity.

- **Africa emerges as D2D satellite battleground** — ITWeb Africa, 23 October 2026 SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  GSMA Intelligence's Q3 2026 satellite tracker finds 13% of mobile operators in sub-Saharan Africa have satellite partnerships, the lowest share of any region against 19% worldwide, and expects broad direct-to-device coverage, Africa included, around 2028 or 2029. Airtel Africa launched Starlink Mobile in DR Congo in August, while early services are limited to messaging and licensing remains the main obstacle, as Starlink's provisional suspension in Senegal shows.

- **PR autoriza 50 milhões USD para levar banda larga a zonas sem cobertura, mas OGE prevê 67 milhões** — Polígrafo África, 23 October 2026 ANGOLA

  Summarised under Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure.

Data Storage

- **Lesotho urged to turn innovation into jobs and economic growth - Lesotho Times** — Lesotho Times, 23 October 2026 LESOTHO

Opening Lesotho's third National Science, Technology and Innovation Week, ICT and science minister Nthati Moorosi said research must turn into products, businesses and jobs rather than stopping at publication. She said a Research and Innovation Policy to commercialise research is awaiting approval. *Also under AI and Research institutions.*

- **Konza data centre set for expansion through public private partnership** — People Daily, 23 October 2026 KENYA

  Kenya's Public Private Partnerships Directorate signed a funding agreement on 23 October 2026 to prepare the Konza National Data Centre Cloud Expansion and Smart City Facilities Project, including hiring a transaction adviser to structure it for a private partner. The project joined the PPP pipeline in December 2025 and is presented as strengthening sovereign cloud capacity; no private partner has been chosen, and the agreement does not mean construction has started.

- **Yaoundé Declaration Targets 100% Local Hosting of Critical Government Data by 2030** — Business in Cameroon, 23 October 2026 CAMEROON AFRICA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

- **Kenya's Konza Technopolis Secures Funding Agreement for Data Centre and Smart City Project** — Tech Africa News, 23 October 2026 KENYA

  Summarised under New investments.

- **Cameroon summit calls for interoperable DPI and sovereign infrastructure in Africa** — Biometric Update, 23 October 2026 CAMEROON

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

Cybersecurity

- **NatCA Boss Intensifies Nationwide NIN–SIM Integration Campaign Ahead of November 1 Deadline** — The Calabash Newspaper, 23 October 2026 SIERRA LEONE

  Sierra Leone's National Communications Authority stepped up a nationwide campaign from 20 October 2026 for mobile subscribers to link their SIM cards to their National Identification Numbers before a 1 November deadline. It is working with the National Civil Registration Authority and the mobile operators, and presents the linkage as a defence against SIM fraud and identity theft. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS.*

DPI

Data Exchange

- **Cameroon summit calls for interoperable DPI and sovereign infrastructure in Africa** — Biometric Update, 23 October 2026 CAMEROON

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

Digital Identity and CRVS

- **Bénin : l'ANIP déploie des tablettes pour actualiser les données dans les arrondissements** — Benin Web TV, 23 October 2026 BENIN

Benin's identification agency ANIP began issuing tablets to arrondissement secretaries in several communes on 19 October 2026, so residents can change the signature and phone number on their record locally instead of at ANIP's main offices. The tablets add to the ANIP BJ app and web portal, which already allow phone numbers to be updated. *Also under Access to services.*

- **NatCA Boss Intensifies Nationwide NIN–SIM Integration Campaign Ahead of November 1 Deadline** — The Calabash Newspaper, 23 October 2026 SIERRA LEONE

  Summarised under Cybersecurity.

Registries

- **ITIE-RDC Données et Divulgation Systématique** — ITIE-RDC, 23 October 2026 DRC

  The data page of EITI DR Congo reports 2023 extractive revenue of USD 5.85 billion, 5.61 billion of it from mining and 234.3 million from oil, from 134 reporting entities. It also publishes the beneficial ownership register set up under Law 25/048 of 1 July 2025 and a ministerial order of 8 July 2026, now listing 202 beneficial owners of 54 companies, two of them politically exposed persons. *Also under Open data.*

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **Togo Adds Building Material and Geospatial Map Requests to National Digital Portal** — Togo First, 23 October 2026 TOGO

  Togo's Ministry of Territorial Planning and Urban Development put two new services on the Service Public portal: ordering compressed stabilised earth blocks and requesting geospatial maps. The portal lists 155 procedures, according to the national digital observatory, and handled more than 400,000 requests in 2024 against 100,000 in 2023.

- **SARS's expanded auto assessments pay off** — ITWeb South Africa, 23 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  The South African Revenue Service reported more than 6.9 million returns auto-assessed by 30 September 2026, 20% more than a year earlier, after extending auto-assessment to some provisional taxpayers, drawing on more verified third-party data and sending assessment notices by WhatsApp. Between 1 July and 19 October it paid R33 billion in refunds to 3.1 million taxpayers, 85% of them within 72 hours.

- **Nigeria delegation to apply lessons from South Korea's digital governance System** — TechReviewAfrica, 23 October 2026 NIGERIA

  A Nigerian delegation led by communications minister Bosun Tijani attended a KOICA training programme on digital governance in Seoul, run with Sangmyung University and the Korea Productivity Centre. Speaking for the delegates, data protection commissioner Vincent Olatunji credited KOICA's help with Nigeria's eGovernment Masterplans 1.0 and 2.0. *Also under Training and skills.*

- **Ministère de l'Élevage : Alpha Bacar Barry présente la plateforme NGAYNAAKO pour rapprocher l'administration des acteurs du secteur** — MediaGuinee, 23 October 2026 GUINEA

  Guinea's Ministry of Livestock presented NGAYNAAKO on 22 October 2026, a platform through which farmers and other livestock-sector actors can obtain the ministry's documents, regulations and support schemes without travelling to its offices. Minister Alpha Bacar Barry said it will work in national languages with AI assistance and will count the farms operating in the country; the ministry had already moved its mail handling online.

- **La CNR lance le projet du guichet numérique unique** — Algérie Brèves News, 23 October 2026 ALGERIA

Algeria's national pension fund, the CNR, launched "Takaoudi All in One", a single digital desk in every local agency where a staff member helps retirees and beneficiaries install the Takaoudi app, open accounts and use online services. The fund has more than 19 e-services and plans more in the last quarter of 2026. *Also under Access to services*.

- **Kenya's Technopolis Authority Launches Digital Platform to Monitor Vehicle Speed Limiters** — Tech Africa News, 23 October 2026 KENYA

  Kenya's Konza Technopolis Development Authority has put live a Digital Telematics Platform for the National Transport and Safety Authority, which registers and certifies vehicle speed limiters and lets the regulator identify non-compliant vehicles. The authority presents the project as a step toward acting as a technology supplier to government beyond its smart-city remit.

- **RDC : Tshisekedi, à moins de deux ans de la fin de son dernier mandat, toujours pas d'État numérisé** — NBS Infos, 23 October 2026 DRC

  Summarised under Public debate and participation in policymaking.

Technology

AI

- **Kenya Expands AI Training to Strengthen Public Services and Digital Governance** — Joint SDG Fund, 23 October 2026 KENYA

  A second Kenyan cohort of the UNESCO-Oxford course on AI and Digital Transformation in Government opened on 21 October 2026, aimed at 9,000 national and county public servants, after 1,239 of the first cohort's 2,730 learners graduated at the Kenya School of Government on 8 October. The course belongs to DigiKen, a Joint SDG Fund programme led by UNESCO with EU and donor funding. *Also under Training and skills*.

- **Nigeria, UK deepen collaboration on AI standards, digital economy** — The Guardian Nigeria, 23 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Standards.

- **Lesotho urged to turn innovation into jobs and economic growth - Lesotho Times** — Lesotho Times, 23 October 2026 LESOTHO

  Summarised under Data Storage.

- **Intelligence artificielle et souveraineté numérique : le Mali face aux défis de la gouvernance et de la désinformation** — Agence Malienne de Presse (AMAP), 23 October 2026 MALI

  Summarised under Public debate and participation in policymaking.

Innovation ecosystem

- **Nigeria's First Lady Lays Foundation for Abuja Innovation Hub** — Voice of Nigeria, 23 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under New investments.

Capacity

Literacy

- **JNPDP 2026 : l'IPDCP mobilise les citoyens pour une meilleure protection des données personnelles** — Levisionnaire, 23 October 2026 TOGO

  Summarised under Data protection.

Training and skills

- **Nigeria delegation to apply lessons from South Korea's digital governance System** — TechReviewAfrica, 23 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Other GovTech and e-Gov.

- **Kenya Expands AI Training to Strengthen Public Services and Digital Governance** — Joint SDG Fund, 23 October 2026 KENYA

  Summarised under AI.

Research institutions

- **Lesotho urged to turn innovation into jobs and economic growth - Lesotho Times** — Lesotho Times, 23 October 2026 LESOTHO

  Summarised under Data Storage.

Inclusion

Access to services

- **La CNR lance le projet du guichet numérique unique** — Algérie Brèves News, 23 October 2026 ALGERIA

  Summarised under Other GovTech and e-Gov.

- **Govt plans 2 000km fibre network to expand internet access in Eswatini schools** — Eswatini Positive News, 23 October 2026 ESWATINI

  Summarised under Connectivity.

- **Bénin : l'ANIP déploie des tablettes pour actualiser les données dans les arrondissements** — Benin Web TV, 23 October 2026 BENIN

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

Data

Open data

- **ITIE-RDC Données et Divulgation Systématique** — ITIE-RDC, 23 October 2026 DRC

  Summarised under Registries.

Geopolitics

Digital sovereignty

- **Yaoundé Declaration Targets 100% Local Hosting of Critical Government Data by 2030** — Business in Cameroon, 23 October 2026 CAMEROON AFRICA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

- **Intelligence artificielle et souveraineté numérique : le Mali face aux défis de la gouvernance et de la désinformation** — Agence Malienne de Presse (AMAP), 23 October 2026 MALI

  Summarised under Public debate and participation in policymaking.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-24**
RETENTION	Kept until 2026-10-31. Older bulletins: the country and region news.
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/bulletin/corpus-bulletin-2026-10-24.pdf
FEEDBACK	info@data-landscapers.io
LICENCE	CC BY 4.0

This bulletin is produced automatically at the end of each data collection sweep but only includes items published on the day cited in the edition, and the previous day. Items published in the last month can be found on the country pages. The links to all items stored in the corpus can be found in the catalogue.

Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country and region news.